

Renewables by 2030: onshore and offshore?

*Testing Malta's 2030 renewable-energy target
against its own plan and Eurostat data*

THE CLAIM UNDER REVIEW

***“Increase the Renewable Energy contribution from
11.5% to 25% through multiple initiatives ...”***

Government of Malta, final updated National Energy and Climate Plan, p. 22 (December 2024).
The summary lists offshore technologies as a means; the plan's 2030 projection counts no offshore wind.

VERDICT: NOT SUBSTANTIATED

Plan's own path; offshore not counted

Version 1.1 · 6 October 2026

Status: draft, pending right of reply

Prepared from public sources and Eurostat data.

Repository: github.com/leandergrech/Mizien

MIŻIEN · AN INDEPENDENT FACT-CHECKING PROJECT

Contest a verdict, with evidence: github.com/leandergrech/Mizien/issues

TL;DR

Malta’s final updated National Energy and Climate Plan (December 2024) puts Malta’s 2030 renewables share at **24.5%** of gross final energy consumption (summarised as “25%”), up from an earlier 11.5%. **The plan’s own calculation does not count offshore wind**, which it says will not be commissioned by 2030; the 2030 figure rests on solar PV on land, biogas, biofuel blending and heat-pump ambient heat. Malta is **ahead of the plan’s own yearly path** (17.2% in 2024 against 15.5%), but the gain has come from heating and cooling, not from solar electricity. The Commission found the plan’s 2025 and 2027 points below its EU reference points (18%, 22%), the 24.5% below the 28% its formula gives, and that the plan does not quantify what solar support will deliver.

- 1

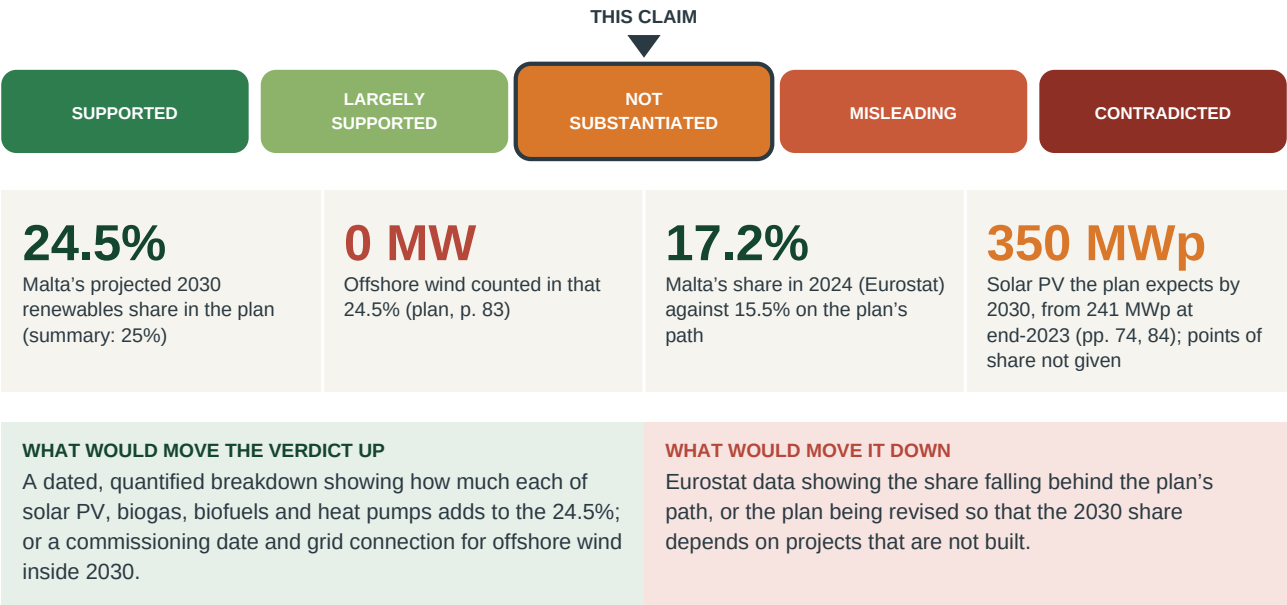
The target is 24.5% (25% in summaries), not 11.5%. The plan says it raises the contribution “from 11.5% to 25%” (p. 22) and projects 24.5% in 2030 (p. 83).
- 2

Offshore wind is not in the sum. “Offshore wind does not contribute to Malta’s RES contribution ... as it is not envisaged to be completed and commissioned by 2030” (p. 83). Yet the plan’s summary table lists offshore technologies among the means (p. 22).
- 3

Solar PV is part of it, but not quantified in points. The plan expects 350 MWp by 2030 (p. 84), from 241 MWp at end-2023 (p. 74): about 15.6 MWp a year. The Commission notes PV support is not quantified.
- 4

Progress is ahead of the plan’s own path, but heat-driven. Eurostat: 17.2% in 2024 (plan 15.5%). The rise came from heating and cooling; the electricity share moved only 9.5% to 10.7% since 2020. The Commission rates the 24.5% below its 28% formula.
- 5

Verdict: not substantiated (moderate confidence); pledge: on track. On the plan’s own path (Commission benchmarks are higher); offshore as a means is not in its 2030 sum.



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1

The claim and what we could verify

Our intake record paraphrased Malta’s updated National Energy and Climate Plan (NECP) 2021–2030 as saying Malta would reach its 2030 renewable-energy contribution “through solar PV and offshore wind”. The plan does not say that, so that paraphrase is not rated. We rate only the plan’s own words, read in the copy the European Commission publishes [1]: the summary table (p. 22) says it will raise the contribution “through multiple initiatives to focus on more diversification in onshore and offshore technologies”, and the projection (pp. 82–83) gives 24.5% in 2030.

Source	What it says	Our access	Status
Government of Malta, final updated NECP, summary table, pp. 21–22 [1]	“Increase Malta’s ambition to a renewable energy share of 25% by 2030”; “Increase the Renewable Energy contribution from 11.5% to 25% through multiple initiatives to focus on more diversification in onshore and offshore technologies”.	Read in full (381 pages).	The claim
Same plan, section 2.1.2, pp. 82–84 [1]	“expected to amount to 24.5% in 2030”; 16.5% in 2025, 20.7% in 2027. Offshore wind “does not contribute ... as it is not envisaged to be completed and commissioned by 2030”. “Solar PV is expected to reach 350 MWp by 2030”.	Read in full.	The claim, detailed
European Commission, assessment of the final NECP, SWD(2025) 140, Malta extract [2]	24.5% “is below the 28%” from the Annex II formula; trajectories below reference points; support for solar PV not quantified.	Read.	Primary evidence
Eurostat nrg_ind_ren; NSO PV release NR 111/2025 [3, 4]	Malta’s actual share to 2025 (provisional); PV capacity 252.3 MWp at end-2024 ♦.	Eurostat read by API; NSO page blocked (403), figures second-hand ♦ (context only).	Data
2019 NECP (source of the “11.5%”)	Not read: the agency’s host was refused to scripts.	The 11.5% is taken from the 2024 plan’s own wording.	Gap

FAIRNESS NOTE

A national plan is a forward-looking document, and the plan is open about its own limits: it states that offshore wind is excluded from the 2030 share, and that Malta’s land area makes land-hungry renewables hard (p. 74). This check is about how the target is summarised and whether the evidence supports it, not about whether the ambition is worthwhile.

2

Method

Question. Is the 2030 renewables contribution what the plan says, will it be reached the way the claim says, and is progress on the plan’s own path?

Evidence. We read the plan’s renewables sections and every passage that mentions offshore wind or PV capacity, then the Commission’s assessment of the plan. We downloaded Eurostat’s renewable-share series (nrg_ind_ren; Malta, Cyprus as an island comparator, EU-27) on 5 October 2026 and recomputed every comparison with a script (*tools/cc-024-report/calc.py*; outputs in *data/cc-024/*). Plan and Commission figures are typed with printed page numbers into *necp_commission_inputs.csv*. Peer-reviewed literature is context only: this is a check of a document against statistics, and we found no paper that tests the plan.

Grades. Official statistics and EU assessments are grade C; the plan itself is grade D as evidence of what will happen (a statement of intent). **Verdicts** and **pledge labels** follow Appendix A.

3 What the plan says

Three figures circulate and the plan contains all of them. **11.5%** is the earlier contribution that the summary table says is being raised. **25%** is the ambition in the summary table. **24.5%** is the figure in the plan's projection and indicative trajectory (Table 3), the one the Commission assessed. A reader quoting "25%" is quoting the plan's summary; "11.5%" is out of date.

The 24.5% is built, the plan says, from "additional effort to deploy solar PV systems on land", biogas from waste facilities, higher biofuel blending in transport, and "ambient cooling captured by air-to-air heat pumps" (p. 83). It then adds: "offshore wind does not contribute to Malta's RES contribution shown in the Table as it is not envisaged to be completed and commissioned by 2030." Elsewhere the plan commits to "a minimum of 350MW of offshore renewable generation capacity ... by 2030" (p. 25) and, in another section, to 350 MW "by 2050" (p. 78), as a non-binding TEN-E agreement. The plan therefore lists offshore energy among its means, while counting none of it towards 2030.

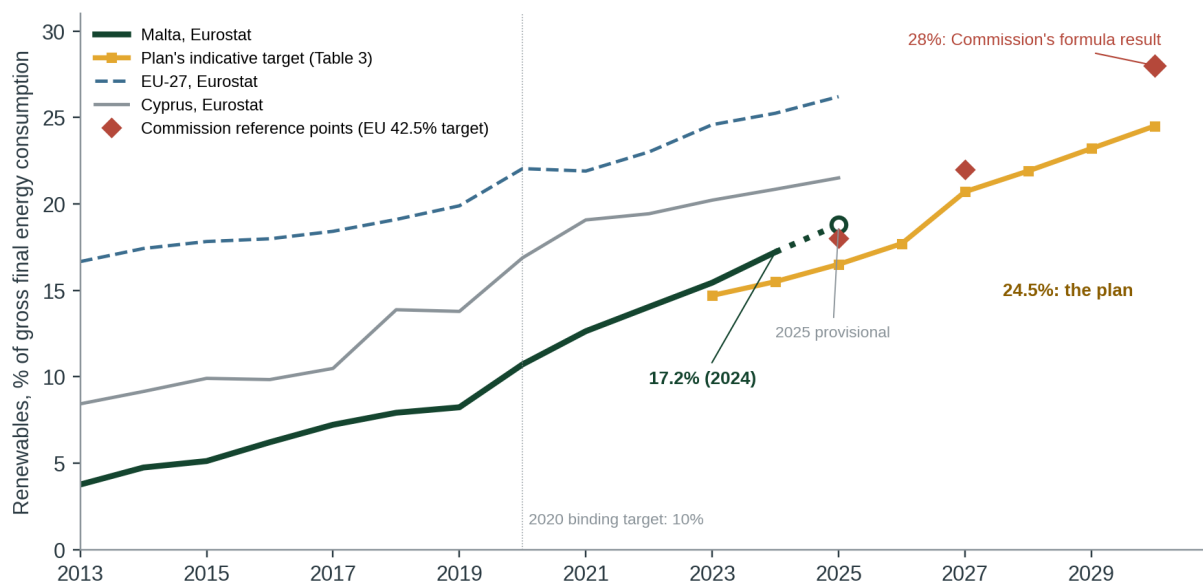


Figure 1. Malta's renewable share (Eurostat) against the plan's indicative target, the Commission's reference points and its 28% formula result. 2025 is provisional (Eurostat flag p).

4 What the data show

Indicator	Malta	Comparator	Source	Grade
Renewables share, 2024	17.2%	Plan path 15.5%; EU-27 25.2%; Cyprus 20.8%	Eurostat [3]; plan p. 83	C
Renewables share, 2025 (provisional)	18.8%	Plan path 16.5%; Commission reference point 18%	Eurostat [3]; [2]	C
Straight line from 2020 outturn (10.7%) to 24.5%, value in 2024	16.2%	Actual +1.0 point above	calc.py	C
Rise needed per year, 2024 to 2030	1.2 points	2020–2024 average 1.6 points	calc.py	C
Electricity share, 2020 to 2024	9.5% to 10.7%	EU-27 47.5% (2024)	Eurostat [3]	C
Heating and cooling share, 2020 to 2024	23.0% to 59.2%	EU-27 26.7% (2024)	Eurostat [3]	C
Transport share, 2020 to 2024	10.6% to 11.4%	EU-27 11.2% (2024)	Eurostat [3]	C
Solar PV capacity, end-2023 / end-2024 ♦	241 / 252.3 ♦ MWp	Plan: 350 MWp by 2030	Plan p. 74; NSO [4] ♦ (second-hand)	C
PV to add per year to reach 350 MWp from the plan's 241 MWp (end-2023)	15.6 MWp	2024 net addition 11.5 MWp ♦, context only	Plan pp. 74, 84; calc.py	C
2030 contribution: plan / Commission formula	24.5% / 28%	3.5 points below	Plan p. 83; [2]	C

Values in data/cc-024/checks.csv. Eurostat now shows 14.04% for 2022, the plan 13.4%: the series is revised, so year-on-year comparisons use one vintage (retrieved 5 Oct 2026).

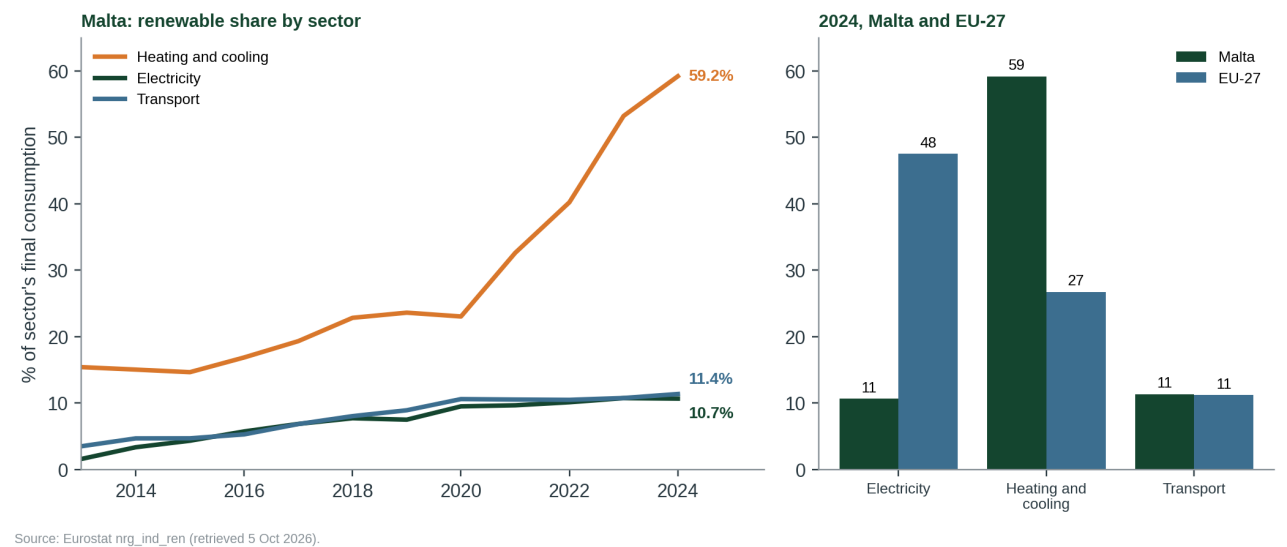


Figure 2. Left: Malta's renewable share by sector, 2013–2024. Right: the three sector shares in 2024 against the EU-27. Almost all of the recent rise is in heating and cooling. The Commission counts ambient heat from air-to-air heat pumps as renewable; that counting rule may explain much of the jump, but we cannot split the effect.

Reading across the data

- **Malta is ahead of the plan's own path** in 2023, 2024 and (provisionally) 2025, and, if the 2025 figure holds, above the Commission's 18% reference point for that year.
- **The lead is built on heat, not on solar power.** The electricity share, where PV counts, rose about one point in four years. The heating and cooling share more than doubled from 2020 to 2024, which is consistent with the plan's

reliance on ambient heat from heat pumps. The Commission’s counting rule for air-to-air heat pumps may drive much of that increase; we cannot split the effect by technology because the plan does not.

- **PV needs a faster pace than 2024’s, on second-hand data.** The plan’s own figures (241 MWp at end-2023, 350 MWp by 2030) imply about 15.6 MWp a year. Against that, NSO’s 2024 net addition of 11.5 MWp ♦ (second-hand) is lower. A rough output check ♦ ($326.5 \text{ GWh} \div 252.3 \text{ MWp}$, about 1,290 kWh per kWp) divides by end-year capacity and so understates the yield per kWp; we do not rely on it. How many points of share PV adds cannot be said from sourced inputs, because the plan does not give it.
- **Cyprus, another island, is 3.6 points ahead of Malta** (20.8% vs 17.2% in 2024) and the EU-27 average is 8 points ahead.

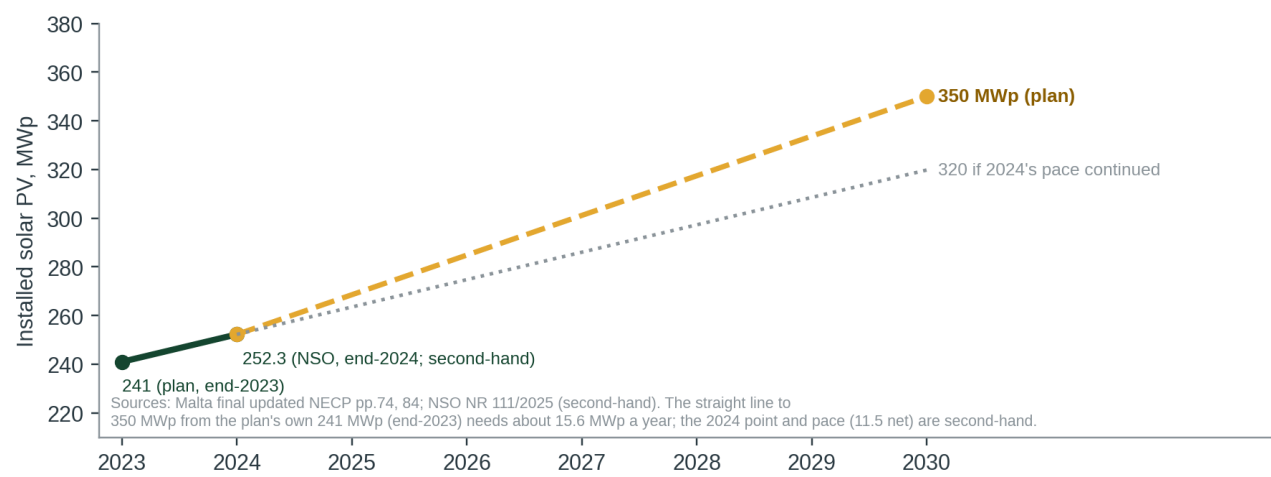


Figure 3. Installed solar PV: plan’s 350 MWp path against the 2024 pace. The 2024 NSO figures are second-hand ♦.

5

Where the evidence points different ways

Q1 Is offshore wind a means to the 2030 share?		LISTED, BUT NOT COUNTED
WHAT THE SUMMARY SAYS The summary table lists “onshore and offshore technologies” as the means and the plan commits to 350 MW offshore under TEN-E (pp. 22, 25) [1].	WHAT THE PROJECTION SAYS The projection excludes offshore wind in terms, because it is not expected to be commissioned by 2030, and the plan gives 350 MW “by 2050” in another section (pp. 83, 78) [1].	
WHY THEY DIFFER, AND WHAT IT MEANS HERE For this claim: offshore wind is part of the plan’s ambition, not of its 2030 arithmetic.		

Q2 Is Malta on track for 24.5%?		ON THE PLAN'S OWN PATH; HEAT-DRIVEN
EVIDENCE OF PROGRESS Eurostat shows 17.2% in 2024 against 15.5% on the plan's path, and 18.8% provisional in 2025 against 16.5% [3].	EVIDENCE OF GAPS The Commission rates the plan's 2025 and 2027 points (16.5%, 20.7%) below its reference points (18%, 22%) and the 2030 share below its 28% formula result; the lead is in heating and cooling, with electricity share nearly flat [2, 3].	
WHY THEY DIFFER, AND WHAT IT MEANS HERE For this claim: delivery of the plan’s own 2030 number looks on track; the Commission’s higher benchmarks are a different standard, which the plan does not claim to meet.		

Q3 Is solar PV enough?

NOT SHOWN

FOR

PV is Malta's main local source, 241 MWp by 2023, and support schemes are kept (pp. 74, 84) [1].

AGAINST

The plan does not quantify what PV support delivers; the Commission says so [2]. The 2024 addition reported second-hand (11.5 MWp net ♦) was below the 15.6 MWp a year the plan's figures imply [4].

WHY THEY DIFFER, AND WHAT IT MEANS HERE

For this claim: PV is a plausible contributor but the plan shows no sum linking it to the target.

6

Testing the claim

Sub-claim	Said by	What the evidence shows	Rating
A. "Increase the Renewable Energy contribution from 11.5% to 25%"	Plan p. 22 [1]	11.5% is the earlier contribution; 25% is the summary ambition and 24.5% the projection and trajectory end-point (pp. 21, 82–83).	ACCURATE, ROUNDED
B. "...diversification in onshore and offshore technologies" as means to the 2030 share	Plan p. 22 [1]	The summary lists offshore technologies as a means; the projection counts no offshore wind in 2030 (p. 83: "not envisaged to be completed and commissioned by 2030").	NOT SUPPORTED
C. Onshore means (solar PV on land, biogas, biofuels, heat pumps) deliver the 24.5%	Plan p. 83 [1]	Named, but the plan gives no points of share per technology; the Commission notes PV support is not quantified [2]. PV: 241 MWp (2023) to 350 MWp (2030) is the plan's own figure (pp. 74, 84).	NOT QUANTIFIED
D. Malta will reach the 2030 share	Plan [1]	17.2% in 2024 against 15.5% on the plan's own path; the Commission rates the plan's 2025/2027 points and its 24.5% below its reference points and formula. A target, rated as a pledge.	ON TRACK (PLEDGE)

7

Verdict, pledge and requests for evidence

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

On the plan's own path; offshore technologies, listed as a means, are not in its 2030 sum. Confidence: moderate.

Why. (1) The plan's summary (p. 22) lists "offshore technologies" among the means of reaching the higher contribution, while its own projection counts no offshore wind by 2030 (p. 83): the stated means is not carried into its sum. (2) The plan gives no points of share per technology, and the Commission found its support for solar PV unquantified and its 24.5% below the 28% its formula gives. Under our scale, a statement made more strongly than the evidence offered allows is *Not substantiated*. We did not use *Misleading*: the plan itself discloses the exclusion of offshore wind in its body text. (The record's earlier wording, "11.5%" as the 2030 figure, was a record issue, not the plan's, and is not part of this reasoning.)

PLEDGE LABEL: ON TRACK (AS OF 15 SEP 2026)

The plan's target is a pledge-like commitment with a date (2030). Published progress is ahead of the plan's own path and of a straight line from the 2020 outturn: 17.2% against 16.2% in 2024; 18.8% (provisional) against 17.6% in 2025. Reaching 24.5% needs 1.2 points a year from 2024, below the 1.6 of 2020–2024. “On track” means on the plan's own path only: the Commission finds the plan's 2025 and 2027 points (16.5%, 20.7%) below its EU reference points (18%, 22%) and the 24.5% below its 28% formula result. The pledge is dated 7 January 2025, when the plan was submitted (the plan is dated December 2024). The label should be revisited when Eurostat finalises 2025.

What this does not say. It does not say the plan is wrong to include offshore wind as an ambition, that the 24.5% will be missed, or that anyone acted in bad faith. A fuller summary would read: *“Malta projects 24.5% renewables in 2030, mainly from solar PV on land, biogas, biofuels and heat pumps; offshore wind is planned but not counted.”*

Evidence we are asking for

- ☐ A breakdown of the 24.5% by technology and sector (PV, biogas, biofuels, heat pumps), in points or ktoe.
- ☐ The date by which offshore wind is expected to be commissioned and what share it would add.
- ☐ The pace of PV additions planned for 2025–2030 and the support measures behind it.
- ☐ The 2019 NECP's wording on the 11.5% contribution, to confirm the earlier figure.

RIGHT OF REPLY

Pending right of reply. This draft should go to the Energy and Water Agency and the Ministry responsible for energy with a fixed deadline (suggested 14 days). A *Not substantiated* verdict is not circulated beyond this site before the deadline passes. Responses will be appended and the verdict revisited.

8**Limitations**

- The claim record's earlier wording was our intake's paraphrase, not a quotation. We rated only the plan's own sentences.
- The NSO PV figures ♦ (252.255 MWp, 11.792 MWp connected, 0.262 MW decommissioned, 326.5 GWh) were read from a web-search summary of release NR 111/2025; nso.gov.mt returns 403 to scripts. They agree with the plan's 241 MWp at end-2023 (implied 240.7). They are second-hand, context only, and decide no rating. The yield figure (about 1,290 kWh per kWp) divides generation by end-of-year capacity and so understates yield.
- The heating and cooling jump (23.0% to 59.2%) may owe much to the Commission's counting rule for ambient heat from air-to-air heat pumps; we cannot separate that from other causes.
- The pledge is dated 7 January 2025 (submission to the Commission), not December 2024 (the plan's date), because the submission (Commission publication page) is the dated, formal act; the claim record keeps the plan's own date.
- The 2019 NECP could not be read, so “11.5% is the earlier contribution” rests on the 2024 plan's wording.
- Eurostat's 2025 value is provisional and the series is revised; the 2022 value differs from the plan's.
- We could not convert PV, biofuels or heat pumps into points of share: the plan gives no such sums and we did not use assumed rates.
- Commission page numbers are the printed pages of SWD(2025) 140; the extract's date is taken from the file (May 2025).
- The Commission's reference points are for the EU's 42.5% target and are a benchmark, not a legal limit on Malta.

References

- [1] Government of Malta (Dec 2024). Final updated National Energy and Climate Plan 2021–2030 (English), 381 pp., as published by the European Commission. Printed pages cited: 21–22, 25, 74, 78, 82–84, 279.
https://commission.europa.eu/publications/malta-final-updated-necp-2021-2030-submitted-2025_en
- [2] European Commission (May 2025). Assessment of the final updated NECPs, Commission Staff Working Document SWD(2025) 140, Malta extract, Table 1 (p. 160) and section 2.2 (p. 163). https://commission.europa.eu/document/download/bf1c1e17-293c-4c50-92ca-1ae663ab6cae_en?filename=MT_Extract_SWD+2025_140.pdf
- [3] Eurostat. Share of energy from renewable sources (nrg_ind_ren), updated 15 Sep 2026, retrieved 5 Oct 2026.
https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/databrowser/view/nrg_ind_ren/default/table
- [4] National Statistics Office Malta (24 Jun 2025). Renewable Energy from Photovoltaic Panels (PVs): 2024, NR 111/2025. (Figures second-hand; page returned 403.) ♦ <https://nso.gov.mt/energy/renewable-energy-from-photovoltaic-panels-pvs-2024/>
- [5] European Commission (18 Dec 2023). Recommendation on the draft updated NECP of Malta, C(2023) 9610 final (read; context for the 28% formula). https://commission.europa.eu/system/files/2023-12/Recommendation_draft_updated_NECP_Malta_2023.pdf
- [6] Mizien. Calculation script and outputs: tools/cc-024-report/calc.py; data/cc-024/checks.csv.

Appendix A: series standards and verdict scale

Every investigation in this series follows the same rules so that verdicts are comparable and challengeable.

Verdict	Meaning
SUPPORTED	Evidence consistently backs the claim as stated.
LARGELY SUPPORTED	Backed by the evidence, with minor caveats that do not change the substance.
NOT SUBSTANTIATED	Stated more strongly than the evidence offered or available allows. May be true in some conditions but has not been shown.
MISLEADING	Omits material facts so that the overall impression is inaccurate, even if individual statements are defensible.
CONTRADICTED	The available evidence points against the claim.

Pledge labels

A pledge is a promise of future action, so it cannot be true or false when it is made. It gets one of these labels instead of a verdict, with the date of the evidence behind it.

Pledge label	Meaning
NOT MEASURABLE	The pledge as worded has no definition, baseline or date against which delivery could be checked.
NOT YET DUE	Measurable; the deadline or term has not passed and no progress data have been published yet.
ON TRACK	Published progress is at or ahead of a straight-line path (or the pledge's own milestones) to the target by the deadline.
OFF TRACK	Published progress is behind that path, and the target has not yet been shown to be met or missed.
MET	Documents or data show the target was reached, by the deadline if one was set.
MISSED	The deadline or term has passed, and documents or data that can be shown say the target was not reached.

Confidence

High: multiple independent lines of evidence agree. **Moderate:** evidence is relevant but incomplete or indirect. **Low:** evidence is thin, second-hand or conflicting.

Evidence grades

A experiment · B observational study with a control or gradient · C review, guidance or official statistics · D assertion or anecdote. ♦ marks a source known only second-hand.

Standards

- **Quote the speaker, not the headline**, with outlet and date, and link the original where possible.
- **Separate the claim from the evidence offered for it**, and say who made which statement.
- **Grade the evidence** and show differing views side by side where the evidence is unsettled.
- **State what we could not access or verify**, and what would change the verdict either way.
- **Ask for the missing evidence** in specific, answerable requests.

- **Offer a right of reply** where a check finds a claim Not substantiated, Misleading or Contradicted (or a pledge Not measurable, Off track or Missed), before wider circulation, and append responses.
- **Correct errors openly** with a version number and change log.
- **Whistle-blow only on evidence:** a verdict of *Misleading* or *Contradicted* requires documents or data that can be shown, not inference.
- **Check every side.** Government, opposition, NGOs and developers are held to the same standard.

Appendix B: revision log

Version	Date	Change
1.0	5 Oct 2026	First issue. Draft pending right of reply from the Energy and Water Agency and the responsible Ministry.
1.1	6 Oct 2026	Corrections after the 6 Oct audit: claim restated to the plan's own words (p. 22) and sub-claims rebuilt on them; verdict reasoning based on the p. 22 / p. 83 tension; "on track" qualified as the plan's own path with the Commission caveat; tag removed; NSO PV figures marked second-hand and dropped as headline and deciding number; heat-pump counting caveat added; pledge date explained. Pending right of reply.